

Sunday, 2 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 28° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 28° 12°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 25° 13°	GLASGOW Overcast 20° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Greater Manchester has a new mayor, with Bev Craig taking over from Andy Burnham after winning Thursday's by-election.

She says the new powers being given to the region will truly change lives. It's a big moment for local governance in the North West.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

A major manhunt is underway after a prisoner escaped from a van right outside Liverpool Magistrates' Court yesterday.

Stephen Grzyb, who is 22, had been charged with burglary and was being transported when he managed to get away. Police are urging anyone with information to come forward.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Fire crews are still battling a large blaze at Dunwich Heath and RSPB Minsmere in Suffolk, though they say it's now 'stable'.

The fire has caused significant damage to the nature reserves, and a fundraising appeal has been launched to help with recovery efforts. It's a real blow for local wildlife.

ENVIRONMENT · UK
- 4

Police have arrested several men in connection with an alleged modern-day slavery operation, with one arrest made in Sussex.

Officers are investigating the serious allegations, highlighting the ongoing fight against such crimes across the UK. It's a stark reminder that this still happens.

CRIME · UK
- 5

The Duke and Duchess of Cambridge brought their children to the Commonwealth Games yesterday, enjoying the netball and cycling events.

They watched England take on New Zealand in a thrilling netball match in Glasgow. It's great to see the Royal family supporting the Games.

ROYALS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 British girl band FLO are making waves, saying they 'want it all' as they launch their second album, 'Therapy at the Club'.**

The rising stars are confident they'll achieve their ambitions, describing the album process as a 'crash course' in music. They're definitely ones to watch!

| ON AIR – What's your favourite girl band from over the years? Are FLO the next big thing?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 2 Glasgow is getting a starring role in the new 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day' film, doubling as New York City.**

It's always exciting when a UK city gets to stand in for a major international location. Look out for familiar Glasgow landmarks on the big screen!

| ON AIR – Which UK city do you think makes the best stand-in for other places in films? Or have you spotted your hometown on screen?

FILM · COMING UP
- 3 Welsh actor Rex Hayes is joining the cast of the hugely popular 'Ted Lasso', describing the moment as 'surreal'.**

He'll be part of a new football team in the show, which is back for another series. It's fantastic to see British talent joining such a global hit.

| ON AIR – Are you a fan of 'Ted Lasso'? What makes it such a feel-good show?

TV · COMING UP
- 4 Former England football star Shaun Wright-Phillips is lacing up his dancing shoes, joining the new line-up for 'Strictly Come Dancing'!**

The sportsman, whose father is Arsenal legend Ian Wright, played for clubs like Manchester City. It'll be interesting to see if his fancy footwork on the pitch translates to the dancefloor.

| ON AIR – Who do you think will be the dark horse on 'Strictly' this year? Will Shaun Wright-Phillips have the moves?

TV · COMING UP
- 5 Ed Sheeran's foundation is expanding to the island of Ireland, initially funding a project bringing young musicians together.**

North South Sounds 2026 will see 50 young artists from Belfast and Cork collaborating. It's an amazing initiative to support emerging talent.

| ON AIR – What's your favourite Ed Sheeran song? And what fantastic local music projects have you heard about?

MUSIC · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **The Gold family have agreed to sell their stake in West Ham to Amanda Staveley's consortium, marking a significant shift for the club.**

David Gold's daughter Vanessa confirmed the plans, meaning new investment and a fresh chapter for the Hammers. It's a big move for Premier League ownership.

ON AIR – What does new ownership usually mean for a football club? Do you think West Ham fans will be happy?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Transfer speculation is heating up, with reports that Arsenal and Newcastle have agreed a fee for Bruno Guimaraes!**

This is one of the biggest potential moves of the summer, with Inter Milan also reportedly increasing their bid for Curtis Jones. The transfer window is really starting to get busy!

ON AIR – Which player would you love your team to sign before the transfer window closes?
FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Ellyse Perry and Alice Capsey were the stars as Birmingham Phoenix secured their first win of the Women's Hundred season.**

Perry hit 68 and Capsey 51 in a nail-biting seven-wicket victory over Welsh Fire. It was a much-needed win for the Phoenix!

ON AIR – Are you following the Women's Hundred this year? Who are your favourite players to watch?
CRICKET · UK

4 **England's Georgia Hunter Bell has set her sights on an ambitious sweep of gold medals in 2026 after winning the 800m at the Commonwealth Games.**

She took the 800m title in Glasgow, and now has her eyes on even more success. It's fantastic to see such confidence from our athletes!

ON AIR – Who is your favourite British athlete to watch at the Commonwealth Games? What makes them so inspiring?
ATHLETICS · UK

5 **Great Britain's rowers have had a fantastic European Championships, bringing home three gold medals!**

They secured victories in the women's four, PR3 mixed coxed four, and a men's four development team also claimed gold. A brilliant performance on the water!

ON AIR – Do you enjoy watching rowing? What's the most exciting water sport to follow?
ROWING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Experts are suggesting that the calming art of 'leaf pressing' is becoming a surprisingly popular pastime for all ages.**

It's a wonderful way to connect with nature, create beautiful keepsakes, and enjoy a mindful moment away from screens. Perfect for a quiet afternoon!

- 2 A new trend sees people embracing the 'slow reading movement', choosing to savour books rather than rush through them.**

This approach encourages deeper engagement with stories and characters, making reading a more enriching and less hurried experience. It's about quality, not quantity.

- 3 The joy of 'rediscovering classic board games' is bringing families and friends together for some good old-fashioned fun.**

Away from digital distractions, these games offer laughter, strategy, and a brilliant opportunity for some proper face-to-face interaction and friendly competition.

- 4 Many are finding peace and purpose in the gentle activity of 'mending clothes and textiles'.**

It's a satisfying skill that not only extends the life of beloved items but also promotes a sense of craftsmanship and sustainability in our daily lives.

- 5 The simple pleasure of 'writing and sending postcards' is making a charming comeback.**

In an age of instant messages, receiving a handwritten postcard through the post is a delightful surprise that shows someone truly thought of you during their travels.

- 6 Local 'community gardens' are flourishing, offering more than just fresh produce.**

They're becoming vibrant hubs for social connection, learning new skills, and enjoying the great outdoors together. A real win-win for everyone involved.

- 7 There's a growing appreciation for the therapeutic benefits of 'listening to birdsong' in daily routines.**

Taking a moment to tune into the natural orchestra around us can significantly reduce stress and boost feelings of well-being. It's nature's own soundtrack.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our socks before putting them on?

ANSWER: LINING THEM UP IN ORDER OF COLOUR OR PATTERN, EVEN IF NO ONE ELSE SEES!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of tea. What is it?

ANSWER: SNIFFING THE TEABAG BEFORE PUTTING IT IN THE MUG, JUST TO MAKE SURE IT'S 'RIGHT'.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'signature dishes' that we're absolutely famous for amongst our family and friends, don't we?**

What's the one meal or bake that everyone always asks you to make, and what makes it so special?

- **Think about those 'everyday items' that you've surprisingly kept for years and years, even though they probably should have been replaced ages ago!**

What's that one item in your home that has seen better days, but you just can't bring yourself to part with, and why?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** On the Moon, the footprints left by astronauts will remain there for millions of years because there is no wind or water to erode them.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Great Wall of China is the only man-made structure visible from the Moon with the naked eye.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£84 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£84 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The world's smallest chameleon is the 'Brookesia nana', which is roughly the size of a sunflower seed.
- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu in New Zealand.
- A polar bear's skin is black, and its fur is not white but transparent and hollow.
- The 'richest person who ever lived' was Mansa Musa, the tenth Mansa of the Mali Empire, whose wealth was beyond calculation.

On this day

Day 214 of the year, 151 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ahudemme (Syriac Orthodox Church).; Christian feast day: Basil Fool for Christ (Russian Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Ceferino Giménez Malla; Christian feast day: Centola and Helen. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Michael Hughes, Irish footballer and manager
- 1977 — Edward Furlong, American actor
- 1935 — Hank Cochran, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2010)
- 1960 — Neal Morse, American singer and keyboard player
- 1992 — Charli XCX, English singer-songwriter
- 1944 — Jim Capaldi, English drummer and singer-songwriter (died 2005)
- 1941 — Doris Coley, American singer (died 2000)
- 1966 — Grainne Leahy, Irish cricketer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1947 — A British South American Airways Avro Lancastrian airliner crashes into a mountain during a flight from Buenos Aires, Argentina to Santiago, Chile. The wreckage would not be found until 1998.
- 1918 — The first general strike in Canadian history takes place in Vancouver.
- 1980 — A bomb explodes at the railway station in Bologna, Italy, killing 85 people and wounding more than 200.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: The largest trade convoy of the world wars arrives safely in the Western Approaches.
- 1922 — A typhoon hits Shantou, Republic of China, killing more than 50,000 people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1923 — U.S. Vice President Calvin Coolidge becomes president upon the death of President Warren G. Harding.
- 1947 — A British South American Airways Avro Lancastrian airliner crashes into a mountain during a flight from Buenos Aires, Argentina to Santiago, Chile. The wreckage would not be found until 1998.

- 1980 — A bomb explodes at the railway station in Bologna, Italy, killing 85 people and wounding more than 200.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 215 of the year, 150 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Killing of Pidjiguiti (Guinea-Bissau); Armed Forces Day (Equatorial Guinea); Christian feast day: Blessed Augustin Kažotić; Christian feast day: George Freeman Bragg, W. E. B. Du Bois (Episcopal Church). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — John C. McGinley, American actor and producer
- 1936 — Edward Petherbridge, English actor
- 1956 — Kirk Brandon, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1940 — Martin Sheen, American actor and producer
- 1993 — Ola Abidogun, English sprinter
- 1964 — Ralph Knibbs, British rugby union player
- 1954 — Gary Peters, English footballer and manager
- 1949 — Philip Casnoff, American actor and director

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1959 — Portugal's state police force PIDE fires upon striking workers in Bissau, Portuguese Guinea, killing over 50 people.
- 1948 — Whittaker Chambers accuses Alger Hiss of being a communist and a spy for the Soviet Union.
- 1981 — Senegalese opposition parties, under the leadership of Mamadou Dia, launch the Antiimperialist Action Front – Suxxali Reew Mi.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1972 — The United States Senate ratifies the Anti-Ballistic Missile Treaty.
- 1959 — Portugal's state police force PIDE fires upon striking workers in Bissau, Portuguese Guinea, killing over 50 people.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)